

might come after a ship of men, but who would come after a ship of the undead? Who indeed?

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

To aid you, below is an abbreviated timeline of the events that take place immediately before and during the adventure. Each attack occurs four days apart, but yet the sites are only one day's travel apart. While not known at the beginning, the four day pause between the attacks corresponds roughly to changes in the phases of the moon.

- *Day 1*: The first attack occurs on the small town of Aleston, consisting of a small mill, a brewery and the houses of the workers.
- *Day 5*: The second attack takes place on a collection of farm houses.
- *Day 9*: The third attack destroys Vig's Dock, a seaside traveler's inn.
- *Day 13*: The fourth attack on the unnamed village that the madman, Yip, lived in. Now the authorities of Phlan are beginning to notice the occurrences.
- *Day 15 (morning)*: The adventure begins as the adventurers meet with Doomguide Yovir at Valhingen Graveyard. The adventurers take the day to investigate in the city.
- *Day 16*: The adventurers travel to the site of the next attack and meet the Gilfron Milon on their way.
- *Day 17 (morning)*: The adventurers arrive on the island and begin their investigation into the strange island folk.
- *Day 17 (night)*: Ixas and the Cult of the Dragon attack.

Ixas' ship ensues at the same time as the crew of the *Audacity* return from their enslavement in the Hells, seeking their revenge on living souls.

OVERVIEW

Shadows over the Moonsea is divided into five parts. In Part 1, the adventurers are asked by Doomguide Yovir to investigate a series of attacks occurring along the northern coast of the Moonsea. In doing so, they explore the city of Phlan and discover a number of clues that suggest the location of the next attack will be a small island fishing village.

In Part 2, the party travels to the village and along the way have the opportunity to gather additional information from a passing merchant, Gilfron Milon and his son Gilmont. They also cross paths with some of the local wildlife.

In Part 3, the adventurers arrive in the fishing village and quickly discover that the poor and degenerate folk may have a secret to hide. The adventurers may choose to investigate deeper, possibly coming to blows with the villagers, or spend their time preparing for the attack they believe will soon occur.

Part 4 details the penultimate portion of the adventure. The Cult of the Dragon attacks the village and the adventurers either succeed in disrupting that attack, or they are captured and taken to Ixas' ship by his kobold minions.

The adventure culminates with Part 5. A battle aboard

PART 1: AT THE OPEN

The adventurers have answered a call to come to Valhingen Graveyard and speak with Doomguide Yovir Glandon, the high priest of Kelemvor (the lawful neutral god of death). Yovir has heard the rumors of the "ghost ship" attacking coastal communities and is worried that it will eventually come to Phlan. Between his Order's hatred for undead, and his civic concern, Yovir is looking for a group of able-bodied adventurers to tackle this challenge. The Order of the Silent Shroud is neutral in city politics, and thus he has decided to sidestep any normal city bureaucracy and act directly before the threat finds its way to the city's doorstep.

ROLEPLAYING DOOMGUIDE YOVIR

Yovir Glandon has toiled in the gardens of Valhingen for nearly 40 years. But despite his dirty, calloused hands and his grass-stained robes, he is a learned man. Yovir is a reserved man, who lets others steer the course of a conversation; interjecting only where necessary. He has little interest in the politics of Phlan, but does wish the best for its people.

The sun shines brightly in the graveyard as you approach the grey robed man, working in the dirt. He turns the dirt with a small hand trowel; several pots of flowers next to him. Without looking up, he speaks with an even voice, "I am so glad you answered my call for aid. If all is as I fear, time may be short. Let us talk quickly."

Doomguide Yovir introduces himself, thanks the adventurers for coming and then quickly gets the reason for his call for help. There are rumors of a "ghost ship" attacking small villages and lone farms or inns on the northern coast of the Moonsea, moving up the Iron Route towards Phlan from Zhentil Keep. No one seems moved to act and the danger draws ever nearer to Phlan.

Use the following bullet points to impart the details of what Yovir knows and what he wants from the adventurers:

- Yesterday, a man from a small unnamed hamlet two days southwest of Phlan was picked up just outside of the city. Raving about a dracolich, and seemingly insane, the man was delivered into the care of the Kelemvorites. The man's mind is gone and it will take some time for him to recover if he ever does at all. The clerics have the man at their temple if they wish to examine him or attempt a conversation.
- There have been reports that a ghost ship has been

haunting the Stormy Bay coast, destroying small villages and homesteads.

- Yovir knows that the Knights of the Black Fist are also concerned about the situation, given that the attacks appear to be moving in the direction of Phlan and it is possible that eventually it will attack the city.
- While keeping a nominal eye on the approaching danger, they are not preparing as much as Yovir believes they should. The Knights did task one of their number (Aleyd Burrall) with gathering information. It is quite possible that Aleyd can share additional information about the attacks.
- Since the Kelemvorites are specifically neutral in the intricate web of city politics, Doomguide Yovir was motivated to act; fearing the arguing disparate groups will not be able to agree and act in time to prevent the danger from coming to Phlan. In addition, rumors of ghosts and liches have disturbed Yovir. These sorts of powerful undead are extremely rare, but unfortunately have not been all that uncommon in the Moonsea. The followers of Kelemvor are staunch enemies of the undead and if they do exist, Yovir wants them stamped out.
- Doomguide Yovir suggests that the party begin by gathering information in Phlan about the attacks, specifically speaking with the recovering madman at the temple of Kelemvor or seeking out Aleyd Burrall of the Knights of the Black Fist. From there they can follow up other leads, possibly taking them outside of the city. If the adventurers have any contacts in the cities (their factions), Yovir also encourages the adventurers to consult with them to determine if they know anything helpful. He also suggests they return to him if they have any further questions.
- If the adventurers inquire about payment, Yovir suggests that although he has no coin to give as payment, adventures often lead to wealth and glory that the adventurers might acquire through their own deeds. He will, however, give them two *potions of healing* that they might use in their efforts. They are welcome to keep the potions if they are not used during the adventure. Yovir has also arranged riding horses and rooms for the adventurers at the Laughing Goblin Inn where they may stay tonight. The horses are a loan and are not theirs to keep. If lost or stolen, they will have to repay their cost.
- If there are any acolytes or clerics of Kelemvor in the party, the group receives one additional *potion*

of healing to take on their journey. (Not one per member of the faith.)

DEVELOPMENTS

During their investigation, it is possible that some parties will want to leave Phlan as soon as possible or might refuse to leave at all, thinking it better to wait and defend the city should the attacks come. Use visits from Doomguide Yovir Glandon to keep them on track or help guide them as necessary.

TREASURE

Doomguide Yovir gives the adventurers two *potions of healing* (one additional if any acolytes or clerics of Kelemvor are present) for agreeing to help out.

THE MIND OF A MADMAN

Following the directions given to them by Yovir, the adventurers can easily find themselves at the Temple of Kelemvor.

A disheveled man with wild hair is tied to a chair in front of an open window. Deep, scabbed scratches cover his face and his hands are wrapped with bloody bandages. His eyes dart around the room almost without seeing, mumbling to himself.

A young acolyte in grey robes changes linens on a nearby bed with restraints dangling from its sides.

The boy nods at your entrance, "You may call me Elden, gentle masters. If you have any questions, I have seen to the man's care for since last night."

ROLEPLAYING ACOLYTE ELDEN

Acolyte Elden Mymn is a young human male with a passive, patient demeanor. He is quiet and easily overlooked in the background. He is fervent in his beliefs, but as he is only just beginning his training, he thinks it better to defer to his elders.

Elden explains that the man is given to bouts of violence, though mostly towards himself and thus the restraints. He has clawed his face, and later began to chew off his own fingers when Elden tried to stop the man from hurting himself. Elden strongly discourages removing the restraints saying that it took several of the brothers to hold him down last time.

Elden has overheard the man speak of the "eyes of the dracolich" and his village being destroyed, but little beyond that. No one knows who the man is, or exactly what happened, only that his mind seems gone.

The man simply arrived in the graveyard yesterday, having wandered in on the road from the west, bearing wounds that already appeared to be at least one day old.

Shortly after the man arrived, a female Black Fist knight with closely cropped blonde hair streaked with gray came and attempted to interview the man. It did not go very well. The man began raving loudly shortly after the knight attempted to question him. Eventually he began barking like a dog and tried to bite the knight before she gave up and left.

The clerics have taken to calling the man Yip, due to the yipping, barking noise he frequently makes.

YIP, THE MADMAN

The madman, Yip, is quiet and uninterested when the adventurers first arrive, but speaking with him is a trying process. He punctuates most of what he says with a barking, yip noise and other nervous ticks while struggling against his bonds. He never answers a straight question, and becomes more and more frustrated and agitated the more he is interacted with.

- Yip does not respond to questions asking his name or who he is, but rather just repeats, "The eyes, the eyes of the dracolich, it sees me... It is coming..."
- If examined, it is clear that he is deeply tanned and has rough hands with dirt under his nails. He is likely a farmer or other outdoor laborer. He has several wounds that have been dressed as well. A successful DC 15 Wisdom (Medicine) or Intelligence (Investigation) check can determine that one is a cut by a small bladed weapon, and two others are badly bruised contusions from some blunt object.
- If asked how he came to be here Yip says "the smalls shambled wet before the eyes, clack, clack, yip, the ghost ship, fog, yip. Blood, and flame, yip, village no more, yip, yip."
- Yip speaks only Common.

After being asked three questions, Yip devolves into yipping and struggling; biting anyone who comes too close to his mouth. This does no actual damage, but is a painful reminder that the man is not right in the head.

SPEAKING WITH THE BLACK FIST

Should the adventurers go looking for the Knight of the Black Fist investigating the attacks, they are quickly directed to a guard station where Knight Aleyd Burrall awaits them.

With only the slightest of effort, you are directed to a harried looking human woman wearing the uniform of a Black Knight. Streaks of grey in her blonde hair frame a face with the hard-won lines of advancing age and a violent life. Turning a stern gaze upon you, she offers, "I understand that you have been looking for me. How may I assist you, citizens?"

ROLEPLAYING KNIGHT ALEYD BURRAL

Knight Aleyd Burrall is a formidable warrior with a keen mind, but the soft heart she hides under a stern frown has kept from advancing further in the Knights of the Black Fist. In her late 40s with grey-streaked blonde hair, she has decided that doing her job well and protecting Phlan is perhaps more important than advancement. She does not suffer fools and counts adventurers among the most foolish of all.

When adventurers first arrive, Aleyd is a little concerned about conversing with random adventurers and directly questions the adventurers about their motivations until they give a plausible story or simply tell her they work for Doomguide Yovir, at which point she relaxes. Aleyd respects the Kelemvorite for his civic concern while avoiding city politics.

Aleyd explains that she has been looking into the attacks and can list each occurrence (the madman's village two days ago, Vig's Dock six days ago, a collection of farm houses ten days ago, and the Aleston brewery fourteen days previous). She is worried that eventually the attacks will come to Phlan, but while she was able to convince her superiors to allow her to investigate, they are not concerned. Phlan is large, and all the attacks have occurred in small villages or lone homes. She has noticed a pattern in the attacks (every four nights), but hasn't put together any reason for that sequence. The travel time between each attack is approximately one or two days, so it must be something beyond just the time it takes to travel from one spot to the next.

She has the following specific details she can offer in response to the adventurer's questions:

- There are no witnesses beyond the madman, but it seems likely by when the ruined villages were found that all of the attacks occurred at night. If pressed, she admits this is purely supposition.
- She has investigated the last site personally, but only interviewed travelers in Phlan that passed through the first, second and third locations. In all cases, the village appears to have been ransacked and burned. Not much appeared to have been

taken, if anything, but it was impossible to tell for certain due to the fire and lack of survivors.

- For the nearby village that she visited personally, she found several old bones that she took to a local healer by the name of Fillistrom Wunderkundoodle. The aging gnome said they appeared to be human "filla-something." Oddly, most of the tracks she found (both skeletal and booted) seemed to be small sized, like that of a human child.
- If the pattern holds, the next attack should occur in less than two days, and in six days whatever the threat is, it might reach Phlan.
- She has no idea where the next raid will occur, but it should be a day's ride from Phlan somewhere along the coast. There are no villages there, but maybe there is some cottage or farm she is unaware of. (This is enough information to search along the coast for the ferry landing, though the adventurers may not know it.)
- She asks to be kept informed of the party's progress, and sternly encourages them to be mindful of Phlan's laws while they continue their investigation. While she likes Yovir, there is nothing he can do to protect them should they break the law.

STARING AT A PATTERN

At some point it is likely that the players will want to research the regular timing of the attacks. A successful DC 20 Intelligence (Nature) notes that the attacks correspond roughly changes in the phase of the moon. Worshippers of Selune, goddess of the moon, receive advantage on this roll.

If the adventurers are unable to discern a pattern, they can employ a sage to look into it. For 2 sp, the sage Delacrae Gentleblossom (female half-elf) of the store All Questions Answered, will spend five hours looking into the pattern of the raids. After that time, she determines that all of the attacks are between the coast and the Iron Route, the old major trading road from Zhentil Keep to Phlan and beyond. The travel time on the road between the location of each attack is approximately one day and even the slowest traveler going only under cover of darkness would make it two days; even with the inclement weather of Stormy Bay lashing at them and muddying the roads. The only settlement between Phlan and the last attack that is also near the coast is a small fishing village on a tiny island just a short ferry ride into Stormy Bay.

As for the pattern of the attacks, the phase of the